

# MyLAIberry

## User manual

*Your library of fanfics and web novels, on your PC, translated and available offline.*

OPEN-SOURCE EDITION FOR WINDOWS · VERSION 2026.10

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**How to read this manual.**

Button and menu names appear `like this`, exactly as they appear in the app. A path such as `Settings` › `Assistant` means: click “Settings” in the top bar and find the “Assistant” section.

01

# What MyLAIberry is

MyLAIberry is a Windows reader that saves the fanfics and web novels you read online to your PC, translates them, tells you when new chapters appear and lets you read offline, with your preferred font, theme and voice.

## What it does

- Brings in a whole story when you paste its address (AO3, FanFiction.net, RoyalRoad, Webnovel, We Tried TLs, Project Gutenberg, SpaceBattles and almost any website with text), or from an EPUB, a PDF or an AO3 HTML file on your disk.
- Translates it chapter by chapter, preserving italics and scene breaks, and saves the translation.
- Checks your works for new chapters on its own and downloads them.
- Recommends works like the ones you read, and watches searches for you.
- Reads aloud, with one voice for narration and others for dialogue.
- Has an AI assistant that knows your library (optional, using your own key).

## What it does not do

- **It does not unlock paid chapters**: if a site charges for them, the app skips them and tells you how many there are.
- **It does not remove DRM** from any book.
- **It does not come with works inside**: the app starts empty and saves only what you import.
- **It does not ask you for an account** or send your library to one of our servers: we have no server.

> **Really free.**
> Importing, reading, translating, checking for new chapters and discovering works cost nothing and need no key. Only the assistant and “better recaps” use a pay-as-you-go AI service, and only if you enter your key.

02

# Install it and check your download

## Download

MyLAIberry is published on the project's GitHub **Releases** page. Each version has four files: the installer `MyLAIberry-Setup-<version>.exe`, the checksum list `SHA256SUMS.txt`, `latest.yml` (which the app uses to update itself) and a `.blockmap` you do not need. Download the first two into the same folder.

## Check that nobody has tampered with it

GitHub Actions builds the installer from the public code, and GitHub signs an **attestation** stating which repository and commit it came from. You can check it yourself in two minutes. Open PowerShell in your download folder:

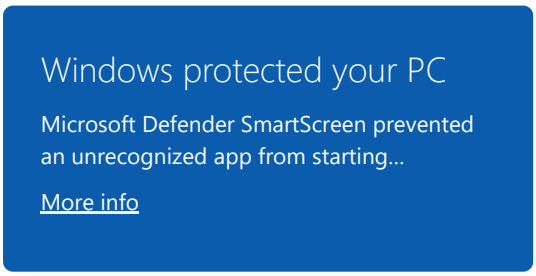
```
gh attestation verify .\MyLAIberry-Setup-VERSION.exe --repo MGPersonalProfile/MyLAIberry-Libre
(Get-FileHash .\MyLAIberry-Setup-VERSION.exe -Algorithm SHA256).Hash.ToLower()
Get-Content .\SHA256SUMS.txt
```

1. The first command (which needs GitHub CLI) confirms that the build workflow for that repository produced this exact `.exe`. If it fails, do not open the file.
2. The second calculates your file's SHA-256 checksum in lowercase; it must exactly match the one beside its name in `SHA256SUMS.txt`.

> **What this proves, and what it does not.**
> The attestation proves where the installer came from; it does not prove that the code is free of bugs. The code is public so you can read it or build it yourself by following the repository's `VERIFY.md`.

## Install

Double-click the installer. It installs for your user account only, without asking for administrator permission, and creates shortcuts on your desktop and in the Start menu.




The installer has no code-signing certificate (they cost money every year), so Windows treats it as "unrecognized." If you have checked the attestation and checksum, click `More info` and then `Run anyway`.

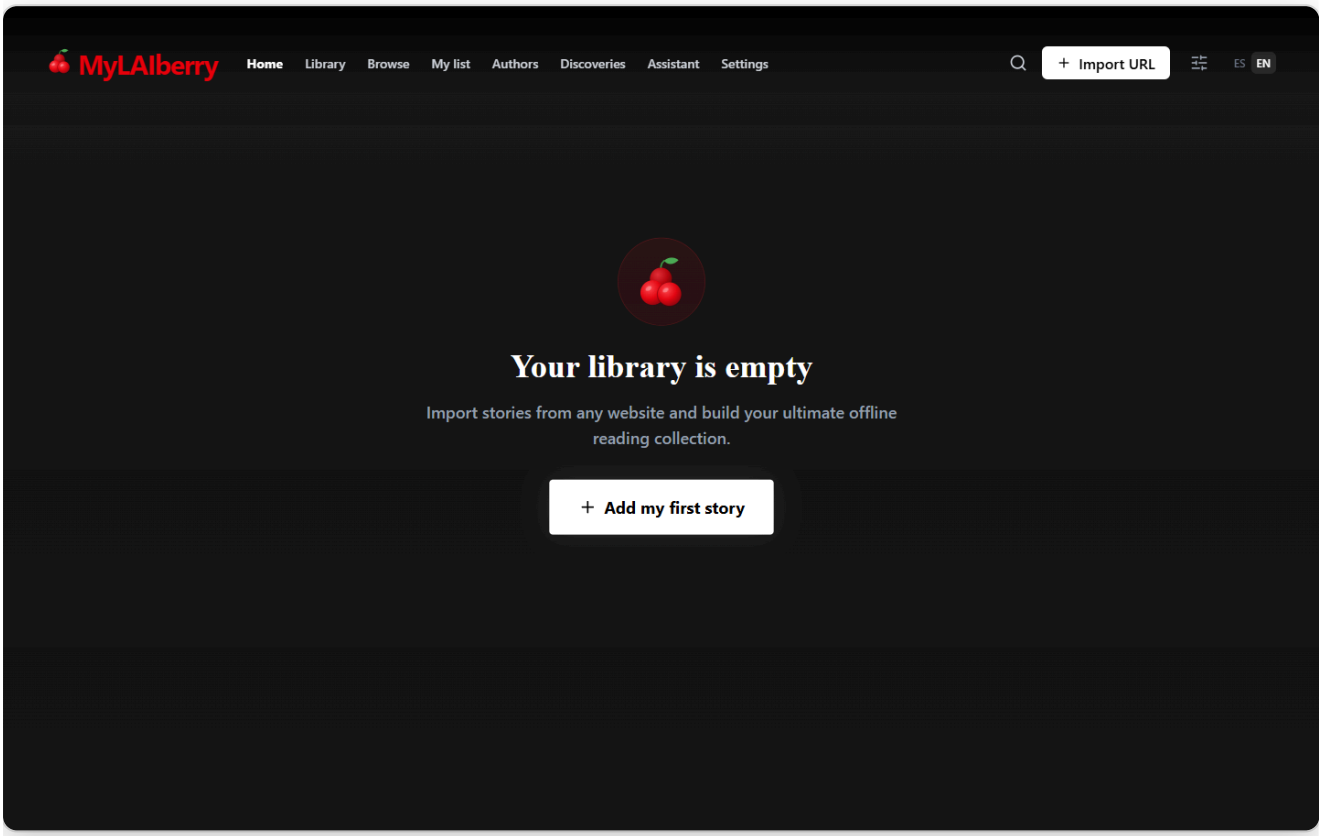
## Uninstall

Go to `Windows Settings` › `Apps` › `MyLAIberry Libre` › `Uninstall`. Uninstalling **does not delete** your library: it stays in your data folder (see "Where everything is saved") in case you come back.

03

# First look

On your first visit, the library is empty and the app asks for nothing: no account, password or key.




The home screen with an empty library. `Add my first story` opens the import window.

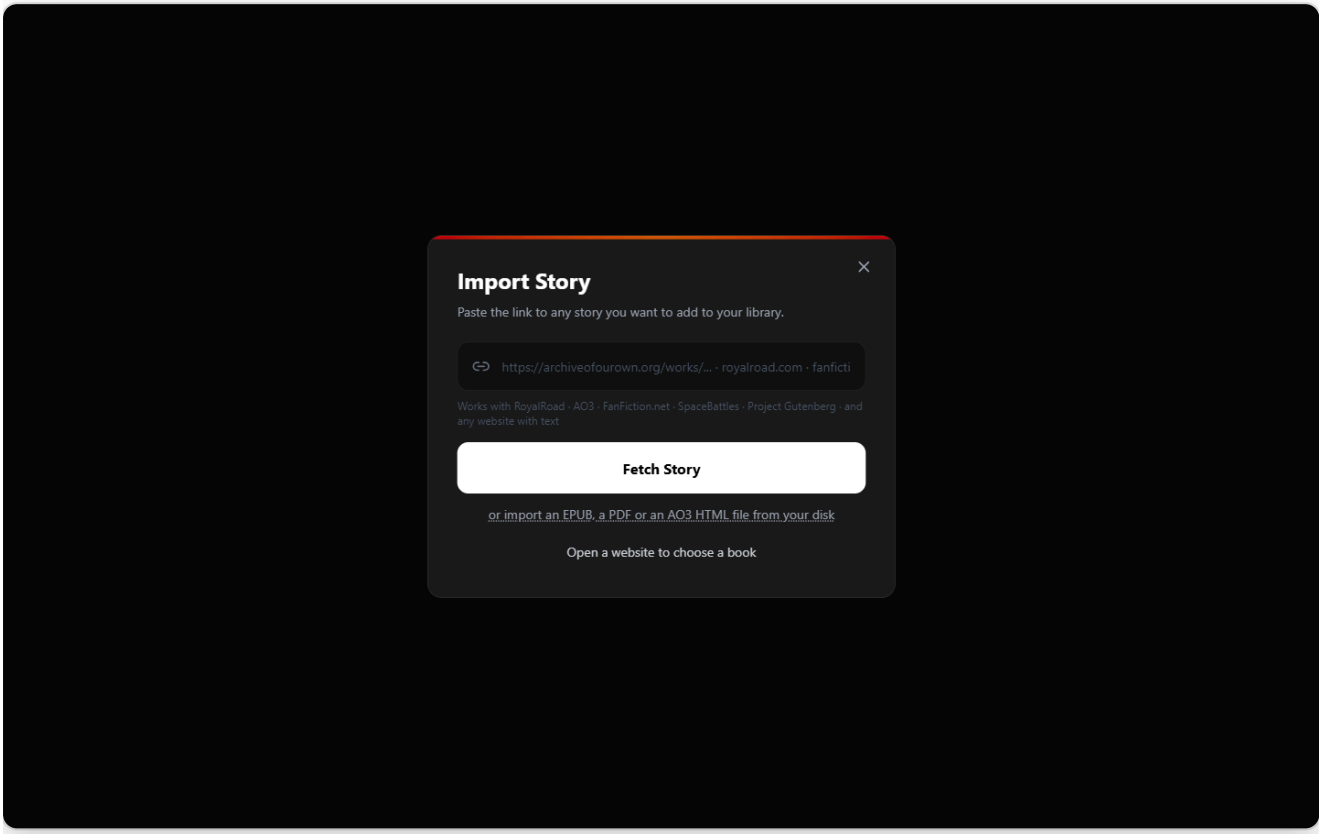
## The top bar

| TAB | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| Home | What you are reading, works with new chapters, recently added works and works you have finished, arranged in rows. |
| Library | All your works in a grid, with filters for reading status and shelves. |
| Browse | Your library by fandom and genre, with the number of works in each. |
| My list | Works you mark to keep close at hand and, while the list is short, “What you read most.” |
| Authors | People you follow and when they were last checked. |
| Discoveries | Works the app has found for you on its own. |
| Assistant | The AI assistant and what it does on its own. |
| Settings | Everything you can configure: translation, reading, alerts, accounts, phone access, storage, assistant and version. |

On the right: search ( Search by title or author... ), Import URL , settings and language ( ES / EN ), which changes both the app language and the language stories are translated into.

04

# Bring in stories




The **Import Story** window.

## Paste a story's address

Click **Import URL**, paste the work's address (either its details page or any chapter), then click **Fetch Story**. The app recognizes the site and tells you how it will import it:

| HOW IT IMPORTS THE STORY | SITES |
|---|---|
| **Native extraction** | Archive of Our Own, FanFiction.net, RoyalRoad, Webnovel, We Tried TLs, Project Gutenberg. |
| **Via FicHub API** | SpaceBattles, Sufficient Velocity and other sites FicHub knows. |
| **Universal extractor** | Any other website with text chapters. |

The work's details (title, author, synopsis, tags and cover) and chapter list arrive first; chapters download afterwards, in the background without overwhelming the site. You can start reading as soon as the first arrives.

**Paid chapters.**

On Webnovel and other sites that charge per chapter, the app downloads only free chapters. The work details say `X of Y chapters downloaded.` and offer `Look on other sites` in case the work is also available openly (AO3, RoyalRoad, FanFiction.net or We Tried TLs). If you bought chapters through your account, sign in on the site through Your accounts and they will download like the rest.

**If AO3 is unavailable.**

When Archive of Our Own is down or under maintenance, the app tells you and tries to import a copy of the work saved by FicHub. If FicHub does not have it either, try again later.

## From an EPUB, a PDF or an AO3 HTML file

In the same window, choose `or import an EPUB, a PDF or an AO3 HTML file from your disk`. The app extracts the chapters, title and cover. It lays out PDFs automatically; the layout is better if you have entered an assistant key. The HTML file is the one AO3 gives you under *Download → HTML*, the format many people use to share fics in their Google Drive folders: it comes in with its author, tags, summary and chapters.

## From a download website

The `Download EPUB, PDF or AO3 HTML from this link` button appears when you paste a direct link to one of those files. If the book is on a page where you need to sign in or click a button (a Google Drive folder, for instance), `Open a website to choose a book` opens a browser window (starting at Project Gutenberg, the large library of public-domain books): click the download there and the book will be added to your library automatically.

## From your browser, with one click

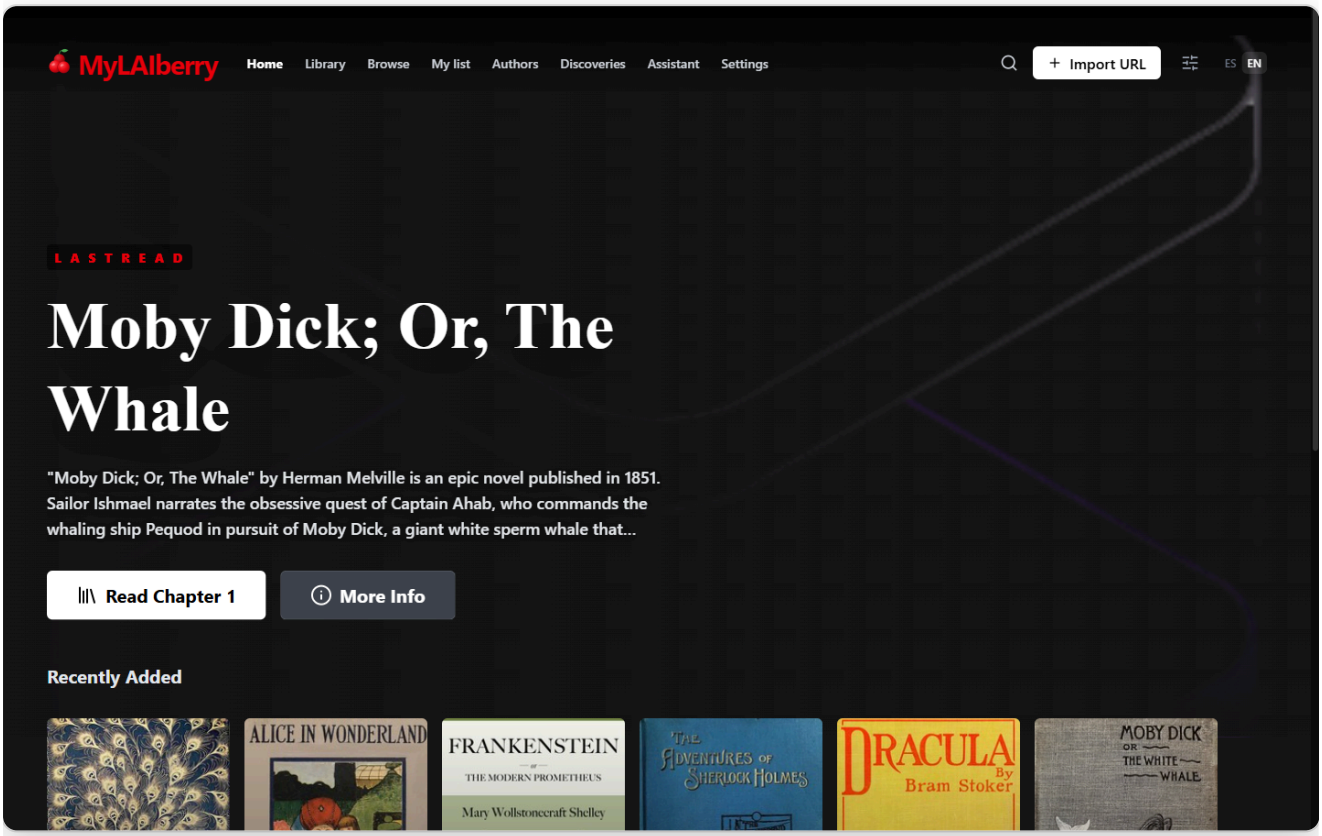
Under `Settings` › `Import from your browser` there is a button, `Save to MyLAIberry`, that you can drag to the bookmarks bar in Chrome, Edge or Firefox. When you are on a work's page, click it: MyLAIberry opens with the work ready to import. In Firefox, use `Copy bookmarklet` and create the bookmark yourself (see Common problems).

## Your AO3 bookmarks

Under `Settings` › `Bring your AO3 library over`, paste your AO3 profile address and click `Bring over`: your public bookmarks come in gradually and appear under `Discoveries`. The first chapter of each work downloads, and the rest download when you open it.

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# Your library

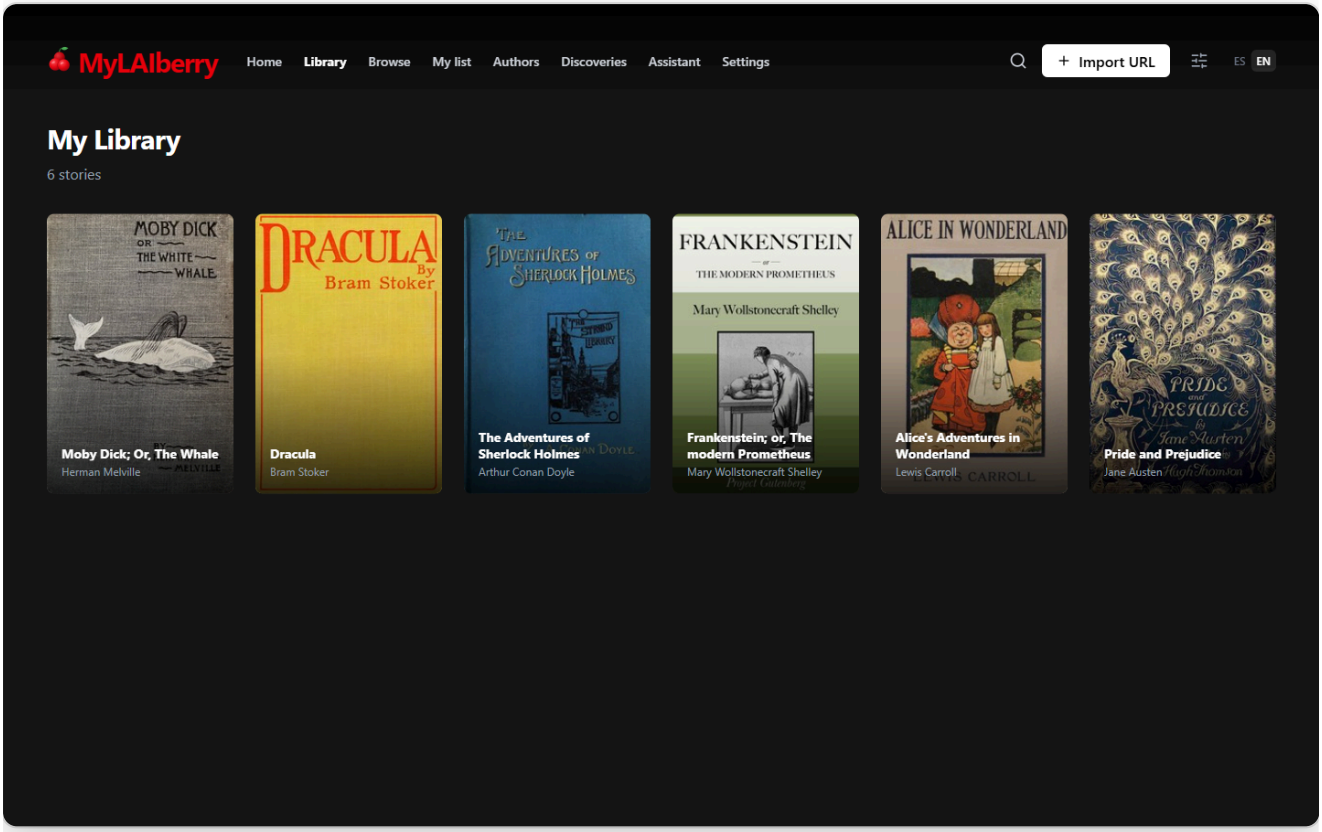



**Home**: your latest reading at the top, then the rows below. (The works in the screenshots are public-domain classics from Project Gutenberg.)

## Home

Works are arranged in rows: **New chapters**, **Continue Reading**, **Discoveries**, **Recently Added**, **Your Whole Library**, **Caught up: waiting for a chapter** (works you have caught up with whose authors have not finished) and **Finished**. Hover over a cover for **Read**, download what is missing and **View details**.

## Library, Browse and My list

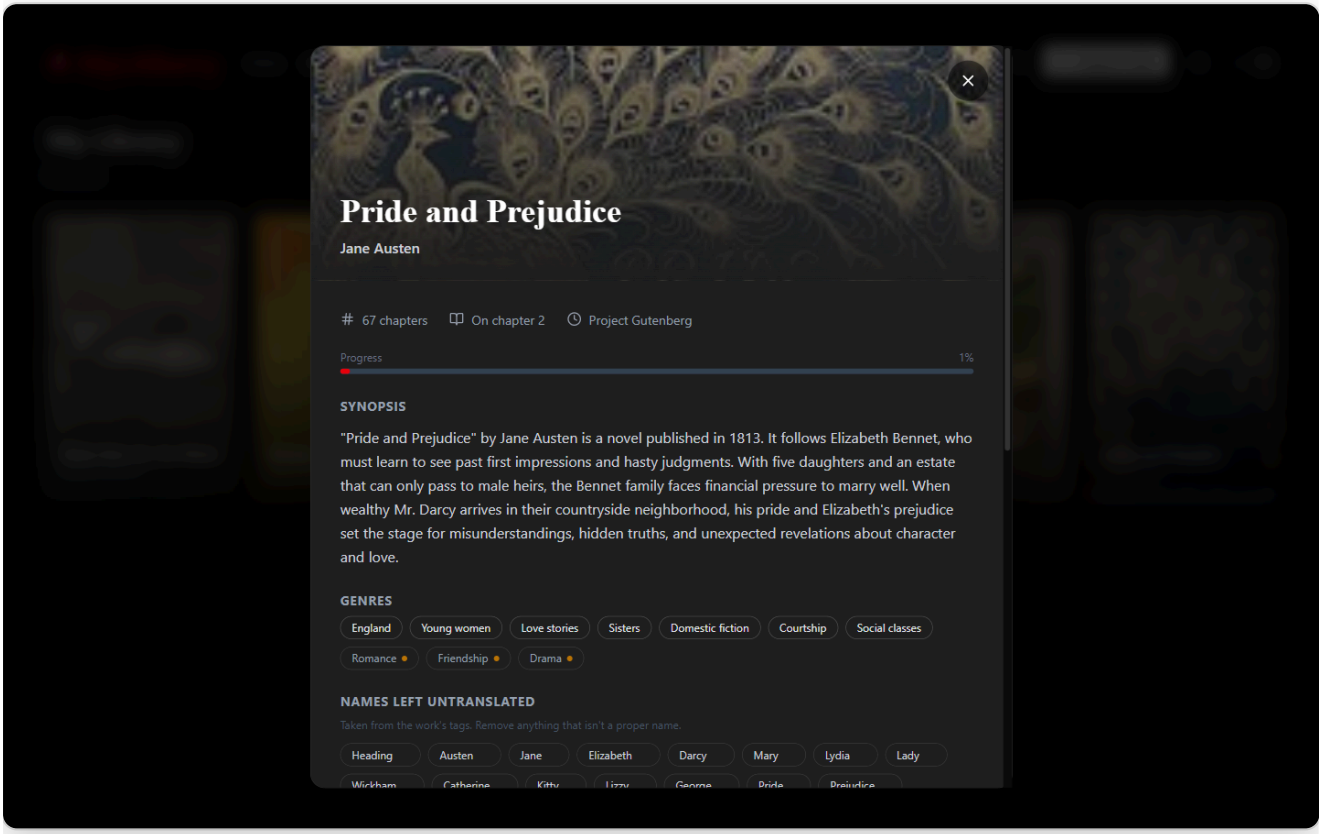



The `Library` tab.

- `Library`: the full grid. Filters appear at the top when you need them: reading status (`On hold`, `Dropped`, `Read elsewhere`) and your shelves.
- `Browse`: pick a fandom, a genre or one of each to see works that match both. `Clear filters` takes you back to the start.
- `My list`: works you mark with `Save to My list` from their details, plus “What you read most” while you have fewer than six marked. The app works this out from what you open and how far you read.

06

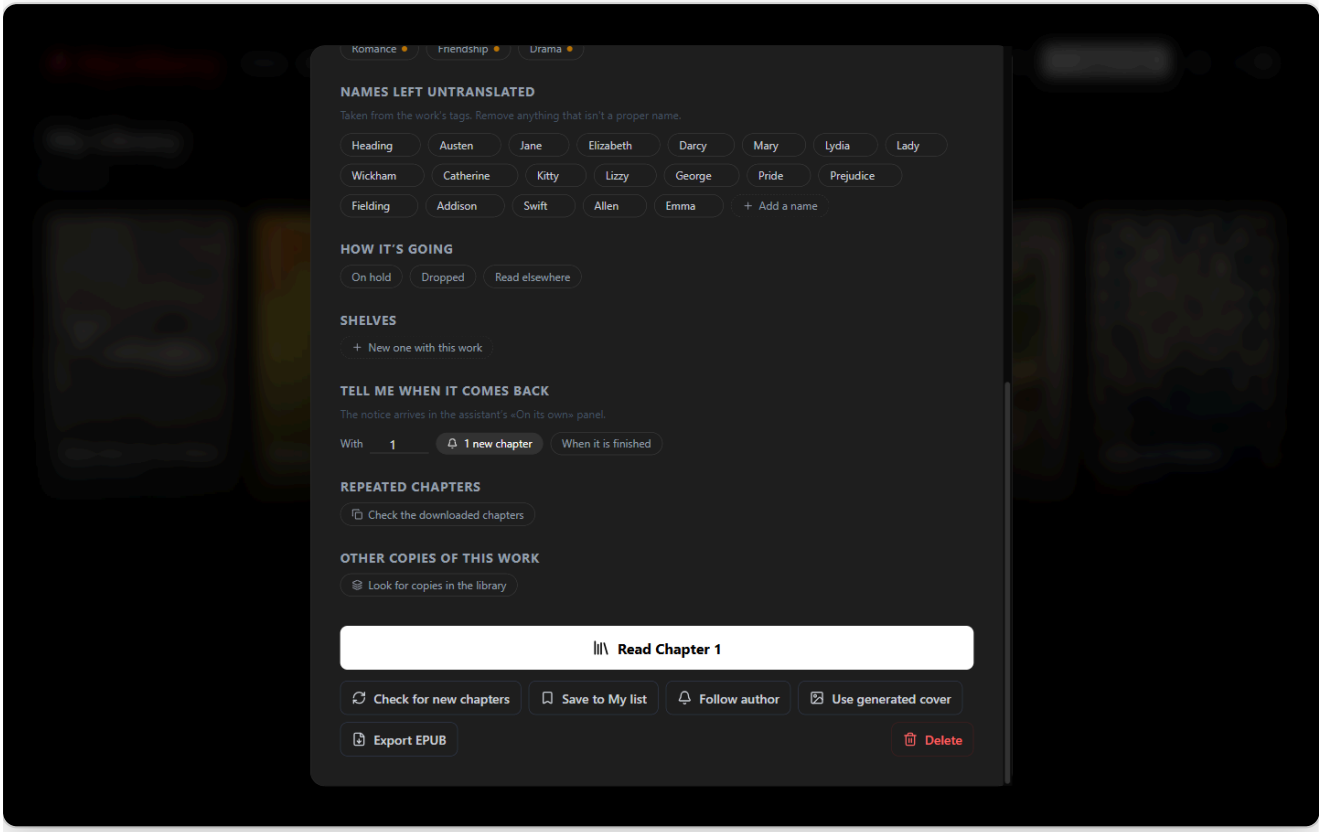
# Work details




Work details: cover, synopsis, progress and actions.

| BUTTON | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Read Chapter N** | Opens the reader where you left off. |
| **Download N chapters** / **Resume · N left** | Queues the missing chapters. You can still read downloaded chapters offline. |
| **Check for new chapters** | Checks the site's chapter list again and adds any new ones. |
| **Save to My list** | Adds it to “My list.” |
| **Follow author** | Anything this person publishes appears in Discoveries. |
| **Use generated cover** / **Use the author's cover** | Chooses which cover is shown. |
| **Export EPUB** | Saves the work as an EPUB for an ebook reader (see Where everything is saved). |
| **Delete** | Deletes the work and its chapters after asking you to confirm. |

## Further down the details page

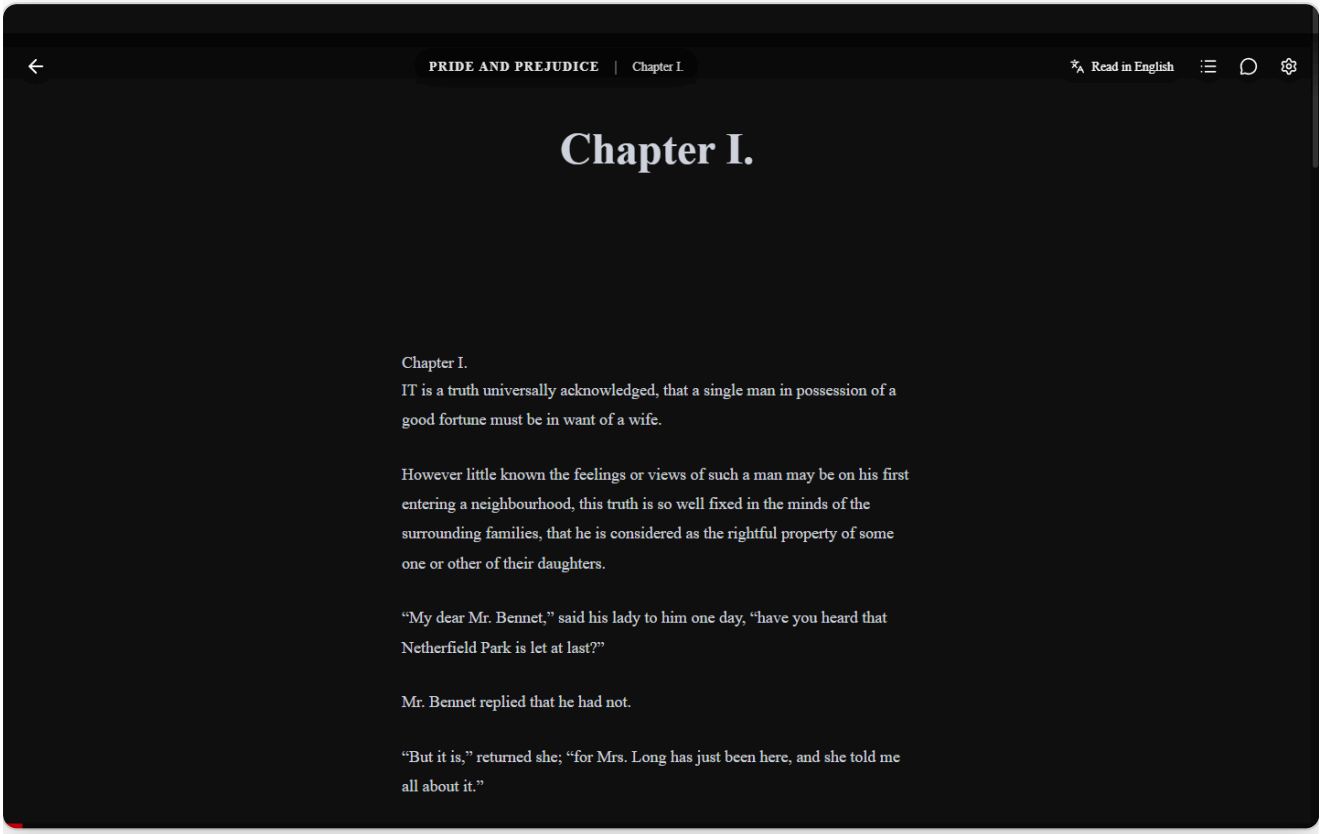



The bottom of the details page: reading status, shelves, alerts and action buttons.

- **Names left untranslated**: the work's glossary (see Translation).
- **Tell me when it comes back**: for stalled works, choose to hear about N new chapters or **When it is finished**.
- Reading status, shelves, checks for repeated or broken chapters, and merging two copies of the same work.

07

# The reader




The reader with the dark theme.

## Controls at the top

- `Read in English` / `View original`: switches between the translation and the original text. The first time, it translates online; afterwards, the translation is saved.
- `Read aloud`: reads the chapter with Windows voices, highlighting its place in the text.
- The chapter list, the reading assistant and settings (the gear icon).

## Appearance

In reader settings, choose a `Theme` (`Dark`, `Sepia` or `Light`), a serif or sans-serif font, and a font size. For speech, choose one voice for `Narration`, another for `Dialogue`, and, if you like, separate voices for `Women` and `Men` (the app works out who is speaking from dialogue tags such as "she said" and from how speakers take turns). You can also set the `Speed`.

## Chapter list and spoiler-free search

The chapter list shows which chapters have downloaded. By default, its search looks **only as far as you have read**; to search the entire work, select `Search the whole work (may spoil)`.

## Always keep your place

The app automatically saves the chapter and exact place where you stop, and returns you there. At the bottom, it shows your progress through the work and how much reading you have left, based on your actual reading pace ( `Settings` › `Reading` › `Your pace` , after you have read a few chapters).

## “Previously”

At the start of a chapter, you get a short recap of what came before. `I remember` hides it; if you have entered an AI key, `Improve this recap` asks for a better-written one.

08

# Translation

Translation is **free and needs no key**: it uses Google Translate on the web. It preserves formatting (italics, bold and scene breaks) and saves each translated chapter beside the original, so a chapter is translated only once and can then be read offline.

Under `Settings` › `Translation`:

- `Translate ahead of time`: prepares the first chapters when you add a work and stays one chapter ahead of you, so you do not have to wait.
- `Always open translated`: opens chapters directly in your language.

## Names left untranslated

Automatic translators sometimes translate people's names (“Rose” → “Rosa”). In the work details, choose `Names left untranslated` › `Add a name`: enter the name and, if you want, how it should be translated (leave it blank to keep the name unchanged). Then click `Redo translations with the updated names`: the translations for that work are deleted (never the originals) and made again when you read.

For several works at once: `Settings` › `Your library` › `Redo translations` › `Pick works`.

09

# Discoveries, authors and watched searches

## Discoveries

New works by authors you follow and results from your watched searches arrive here, ranked by how well they match what you read. Each card tells you why it is here. The app downloads only the first chapter of each work: `Save to my library` adds the work to your library, while `Not interested` removes it for good. Use `Filters` to sort and narrow results by source, status, chapters, words, kudos and tags.

## Authors

Choose `Follow author` from a work's details. The `Authors` tab shows whom you follow, when each was last checked and how many of their works you have; `Unfollow` removes them.

## Watched searches

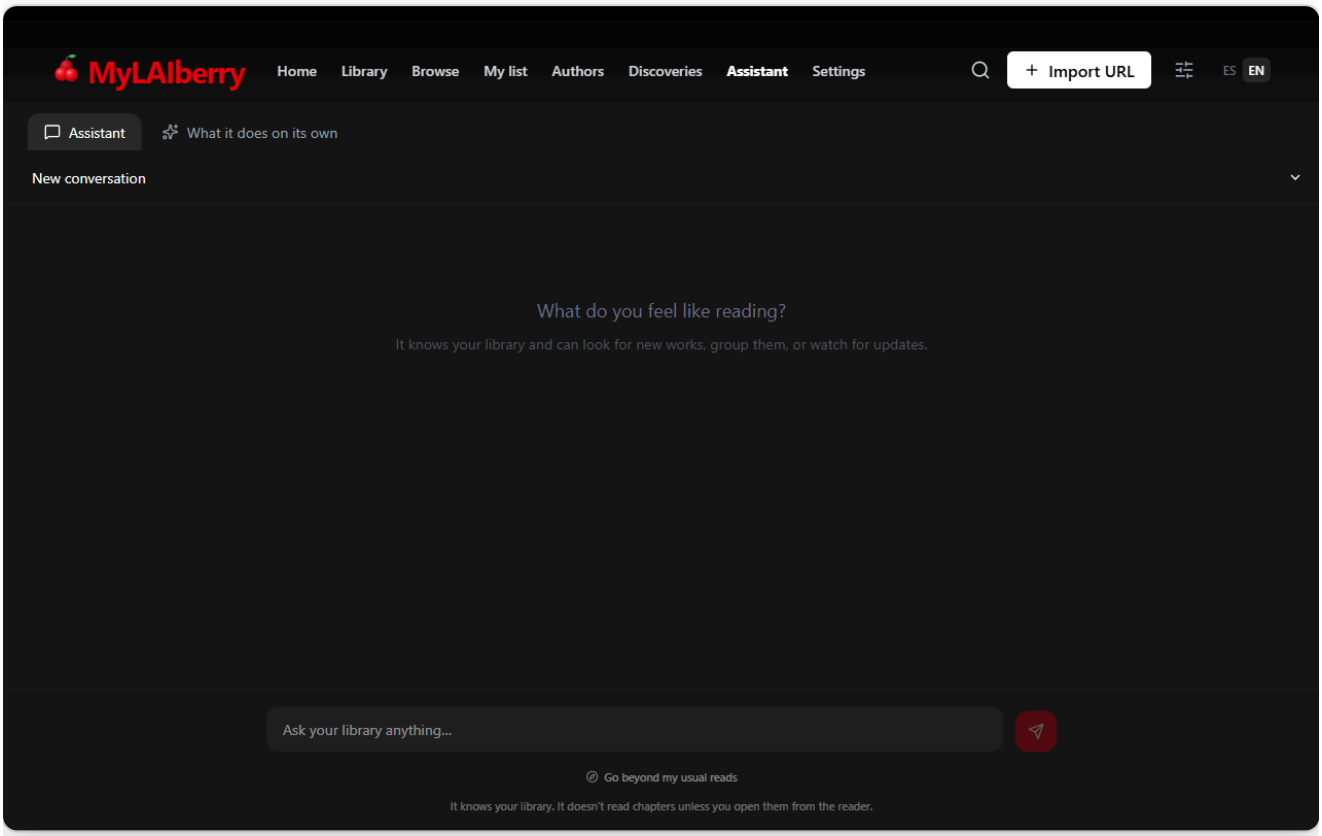
Under `Settings` › `Watched searches`, enter a search (for example, *time travel*) and minimum requirements for kudos, words and chapters, or choose `complete only`. Click `Watch`. The app repeats the search from time to time on AO3, FanFiction.net, RoyalRoad and other sources, and works that meet your requirements appear in Discoveries. This keeps abandoned two-chapter works out of your results.

## New-chapter alerts

Under `Settings` › `Alerts`, choose `Tell me about new chapters` and `Keep watching with the window closed` (the app stays in the system tray beside the clock instead of quitting). New chapters download on their own and appear in the `New chapters` row on Home. `Settings` › `Your library` › `Check all` runs the check right away.

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# The assistant




The `Assistant` tab.

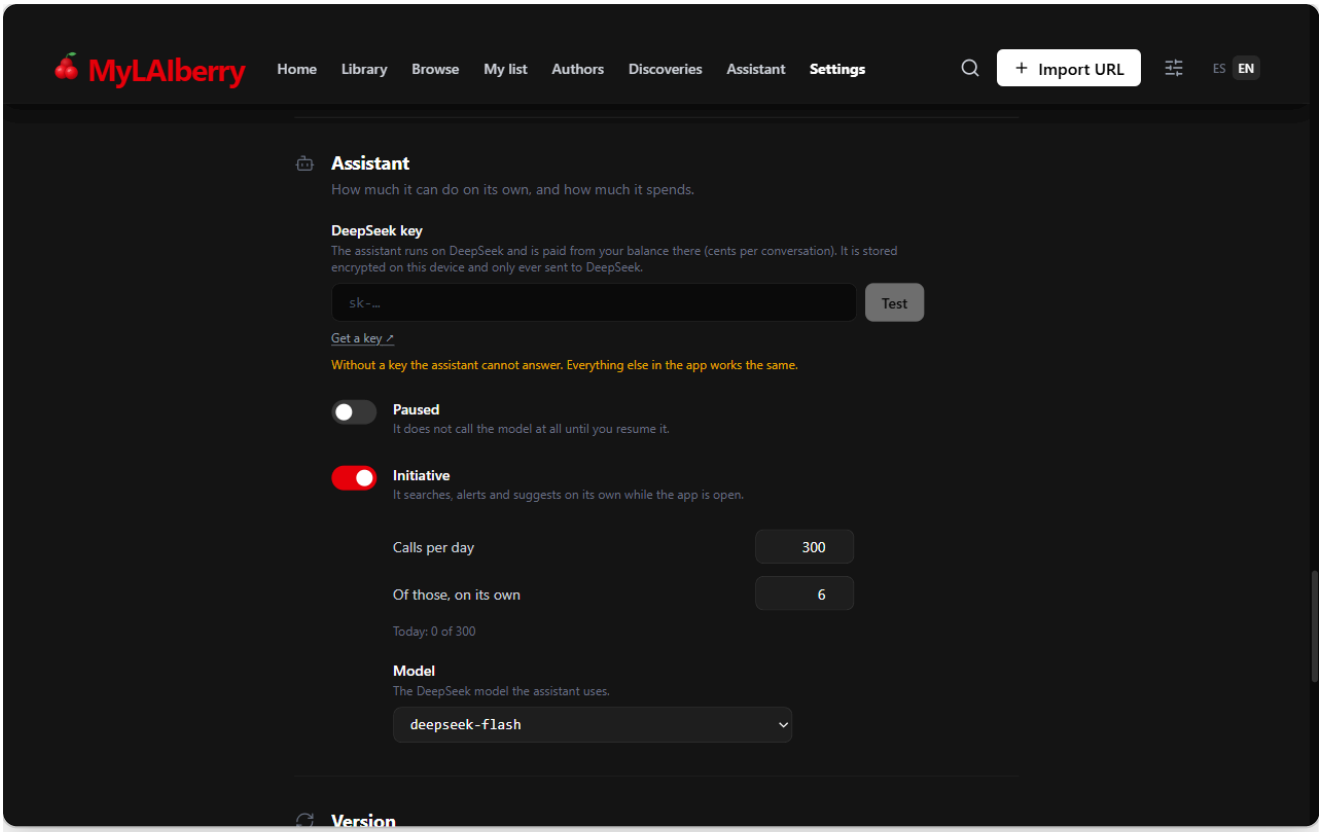
The assistant is a chat that knows your library and can act on it: search for works online, find a story you remember only in fragments, organize shelves, tell you where you stopped reading, watch works… There are two:

- **The one in the Assistant tab**, which knows your whole library.
- **The one in the reader** (the speech bubble among the controls), which knows only what you have read up to your current paragraph. You can ask “Who was this person?” without fear of spoilers.

## Enter your key

The assistant uses **DeepSeek**, a prepaid AI service that charges for what you use (a conversation costs cents). The app does not include a key: enter your own.

1. Create an account at **platform.deepseek.com**, add some credit and create an API key (`Settings` › `Assistant` has a link to get one).
2. Under `Settings` › `Assistant` › `DeepSeek key`, paste it and leave the field: it is saved encrypted for your Windows user account and is never shown again.
3. Click `Test`: it should say `The key works.` (this uses no credit).




Settings › Assistant.

## Control spending

- Paused: the assistant makes no model calls until you resume it.
- Initiative: lets it search, alert you and suggest things on its own while the app is open.
- Calls per day and Of those, on its own: daily limits; the app shows how many calls it has made today.
- Model: the DeepSeek model it uses (the cheapest one is enough for almost everything).

When it wants to change your library (delete, move or download a lot), it first shows you a card with Do it; almost everything can be undone.

> **What leaves your PC.**
>
> To answer you, the assistant sends DeepSeek your question and any excerpts it needs from works or your library. If you are not comfortable with that, do not enter a key; the rest of the app works just the same.

## Better recaps with another provider

"Previously" recaps can use another service: under Settings › Better recaps, choose Google Gemini (which has a free tier), Anthropic (Claude) or an OpenAI-compatible provider (OpenAI, OpenRouter, Groq or a model on your PC, using its address), enter its key and click Test.

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# Your accounts on other sites

Some works are visible only when you are signed in (restricted AO3 works, age-gated content, chapters you bought). Under `Settings` › `Your accounts`, `Sign in` opens the **site's own** sign-in page in a window. You enter your username and password there, and they go straight to the site. MyLAIberry does not see or save your password; it keeps only your session (the cookie), as your browser would. `Sign out` removes it. Under `Another site`, you can sign in to any other website.

> **"Are you human?" checks.**
>
> If a site shows a security check, the app waits a little and reloads the page. If the site still asks for the check, it shows you the window so you can complete it yourself. The app never answers it for you.

12

# Read on your phone

Your PC can serve your library to your phone without opening any port to the internet or your Wi-Fi. It uses **Tailscale**, a free encrypted private network for personal use.

1. Install Tailscale on your PC and phone, then sign in on both with the same account.
2. Under `Settings` › `Read on your phone`, turn on `Serve the library` (it starts off: nothing is served until you turn it on). An address with a secret code appears.
3. Open that address in your phone's browser and choose `Add to Home screen` from its menu: it becomes another app, and you can read what you have opened offline.

What you read on your phone is saved on your PC. `Always available` turns the service on when MyLAIberry opens, `Open with Windows` starts the app when you sign in (both start off), and `Change the code (anyone with the old address loses access)` invalidates the previous address (use it if you shared that address with someone by mistake).

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# Where everything is saved, backups and EPUB

## Your folder

By default, your library lives in `%APPDATA%\mylaiberry-libre` (type that into File Explorer's address bar). Settings › Storage shows the folder, opens it (Open) and moves it (Change folder). The old folder is not deleted.

> **The same library on two PCs.**
> If you move it to a Google Drive, OneDrive or Dropbox folder, you can choose Open an existing library on another PC with MyLAIberry and select that folder. If both PCs change it at the same time, the app warns you about the conflict instead of overwriting anything.

## Backups

One is made automatically each day: it saves your progress, notes, glossaries and what the assistant knows (chapters are left out because they can be downloaded again). Under Settings › Storage › Backups, Restore returns to a backup; the app first saves another copy of the current state in case you change your mind.

## Export to EPUB

In the work details, Export EPUB creates an ebook containing the cover, synopsis and downloaded chapters, in the language you are reading. It is for reading yourself on an ebook reader; do not share it (see Responsible use).

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# Neural voices (optional)

“Read aloud” works with Windows voices without installing anything. If you want a chapter, or a whole work, as an **MP3** with more natural voices—one for narration and others for women and men—the app uses **Piper**, a free speech synthesizer that runs on your PC: the text is not sent to a speech service.

## Install them with one button

1. Open a chapter, enter the reader settings and find `This chapter as MP3`.
2. Click `Install voices (≈ 600 MB)`. You will see its progress; if it stops, click again: files that have already downloaded and been checked will not download again.
3. When it finishes, click `Make it with neural voices`, then `Download the MP3` when it is ready. `The whole work` prepares the remaining chapters in the background.

The button downloads fixed versions and checks each file's SHA-256 checksum before using it; everything goes in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\piper`. If a chapter has been translated, the translation is read.

## What downloads, and under which license

None of these files comes with MyLAIberry: they come from their creators to your computer. **The voices are for your own, noncommercial listening**: six of the seven are based on the Lessac corpus, whose license is for research only, and two are also based on Hi-Fi Captain (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0).

| WHAT | ROLE | LICENSE |
|---|---|---|
| Piper 2023.11.14-2 | speech synthesizer | MIT (includes espeak-ng, GPL-3.0) |
| ffmpeg 9.0.2 | joins segments into an MP3 | GPL-3.0 |
| `es_MX-claude-high` | Spanish narration | Apache-2.0 data |
| `es_ES-sharvard-medium` | Spanish women and dialogue | CC BY 3.0 data, based on Lessac |
| `es_ES-davefx-medium` | Spanish men | CC0 data, based on Lessac |
| `en_US-lessac-medium` | English narration | Lessac: research only |
| `en_US-hfc_female-medium` | English women | CC BY-NC-SA 4.0, based on Lessac |
| `en_US-hfc_male-medium` | English men | CC BY-NC-SA 4.0, based on Lessac |
| `en_US-joe-medium` | English dialogue | CC0 data, based on Lessac |

## Install them manually

If you prefer to do it yourself: get Piper for Windows from `github.com/rhasspy/piper` (“Releases”), so that it is at `%LOCALAPPDATA%\piper\piper\piper.exe`; get the voices (each has two files, `.onnx` and `.onnx.json`) from `huggingface.co/rhasspy/piper-voices` and put them in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\piper\voces\`; put `ffmpeg.exe` in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\piper\ffmpeg\` or on your PATH. The narration voice alone is enough: it fills in for any missing roles.

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# Update

MyLAIberry does not update itself secretly. When a new version is released, you see a notice ( `A new version is ready: {version}` ) and, under `Settings` › `Version`, an `Update to {version}` button. When you click it, the app downloads the installer from the project's Releases, checks that its size and SHA-512 checksum match the published values, and only then runs it. The app closes and reopens. Your library is untouched.

16

# Privacy: which sites the app contacts

MyLAIberry has no server, account or usage tracking. Your library, progress and notes stay on your PC. The app connects only to these sites, plus pages that you or the assistant open in its browser:

| WHO | WHY | WHEN |
|---|---|---|
| Work sites (AO3, FanFiction.net, RoyalRoad…) | Download details, chapter lists and chapters | When importing and checking for updates |
| FicHub | Works from sites it supports, and saved copies when AO3 is down | When importing |
| Google Translate | Translate | When translating a chapter or synopsis |
| AniList, Fandom and Bing Images | Background images for each fandom, saved on your PC | From time to time |
| Open Library, archive.org, Standard Ebooks | Tell you where a book is published | If you ask |
| DeepSeek (and your chosen recap provider) | The assistant and better recaps | Only when you enter your key |
| Project Gutenberg | Public-domain books | When importing from a website |
| DuckDuckGo and Bing | Search the internet for the assistant | When you ask the assistant |
| Reddit, Wattpad, Webnovel and We Tried TLs | Recommendations and works from those sites | When you import from them or the assistant searches |
| ntfy.sh | Alerts on your phone | Only if you set up an alert channel |
| GitHub | Check for and download new versions | When the app opens and when updating |
| GitHub and Hugging Face | Piper, ffmpeg and the voices | Only when you click `Install voices (≈ 600 MB)` |

The keys you enter are stored encrypted for your Windows user account and are never sent to anyone but their respective services.

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# Responsible use

MyLAIberry is a reading tool, like a browser with a memory. The stories you save belong to their authors.

- **What you save is for your own reading.** Do not upload or share the works or EPUBs you export: that is for their authors to decide.
- **Support the writers.** Leave kudos, comments and reviews on the original site; if a site sells chapters, buy them there.
- **Respect each site's rules.** The app deliberately downloads slowly and stops if a site asks it to wait. Do not use it to download entire sites.
- **Import only works you have the right to read.** The EPUB and PDF importer is for your DRM-free books and public-domain works; do not use it with pirated copies.

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# Common problems

### Windows says the installer is “unrecognized.”

It is not signed with a paid certificate. Check the attestation and checksum (chapter 2) and, if they match, click `More info` › `Run anyway`.

### The assistant says it has no key or does not answer.

Enter your DeepSeek key under `Settings` › `Assistant` and click `Test`. If the test says it works but the assistant still does not answer, check that it is not `Paused`, that you have not reached `Calls per day` and that your DeepSeek account has credit.

### Does translation cost money?

No. It needs neither a key nor an account. If Google temporarily limits it, the app tells you and shows `Try again`.

### A work stops downloading partway through.

Sites sometimes limit repeated requests; the app waits and continues on its own. You can close the app: it resumes the queue when you return. If a chapter is broken, check the chapters in the work details and repair the work.

### Webnovel says “30 of 477 chapters downloaded.”

The others are paid chapters on Webnovel. Buy them there (and sign in under `Your accounts`), or click `Look on other sites` in case the work is also legally available for free elsewhere.

### I changed a name in the glossary, but chapters I read still look the same.

Each chapter is translated once and saved. Click `Redo translations with the updated names` in the work details.

### “This chapter as MP3” says the voices are not installed.

This optional feature is installed separately; see Neural voices. To listen without installing anything, use `Read aloud`.

### I cannot drag “Save to MyLAIberry” in Firefox.

Click `Copy bookmarklet`. In Firefox, right-click the bookmarks bar › `Add Bookmark…`, name it “Save to MyLAIberry” and paste what you copied into its address.

### My phone cannot connect even though it is on the same Wi-Fi.

This is intentional: the app opens no port on your network. Tailscale must be signed in on both the PC and phone (see Read on your phone).

### “Your pace” says “Not yet: {n} more chapters read to measure it.”

It needs a few chapters read within the app to measure your actual words per minute.

### How do I move my library to a new PC?

Copy the folder (**Settings** › **Storage** › **Open**) to the new PC and choose **Open an existing library** there. Or keep it in a synced folder and open it from both PCs. Encrypted keys do not travel with it: enter them again.

### I want to delete everything.

Uninstall the app and delete `%APPDATA%\mylaiberry-libre` (and your library folder, if you moved it elsewhere).

*MyLAIberry is free software. Its code, known bugs and feature requests are in its GitHub repository.*

# License

MyLAIberry is distributed under the **GNU Affero General Public License, version 3 or later (AGPL-3.0-or-later)**.

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